

Science Professional Development

Science

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Science Professional Development (A32621)

Short Title: Sci Professional Development
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Placement and Projects
Author TKENT
Credits 30

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

The Science Professional Development module is an elective module designed as an alternative to the Work Placement module in Science programmes, taken by the student with prior agreement with the module supervisor. This module facilitates the student to reflect on their own professional aims and motivation for learning, to identify gaps in their professional knowledge and take the initiative and responsibility for meeting their own learning needs. This mode of learning recognises the student's agency in taking responsibility for their learning with the support of the module supervisor. This module will offer the student a broad range of professional experience. In addition to gaining specialised knowledge and skills, participating students will demonstrate the acquisition of many transferable skills. These will include individual initiative and personal responsibility, learning flexibly, operating and communicating effectively in a multi-disciplinary environment and specialised knowledge transfer.

Programmes

SCIE-0085	BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (WD_SAGRI_B)	3 / 6 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc (Hons) in Food Science and Innovation (WD_SFSIN_B)	3 / 5 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc (Hons) in Molecular Biology with Biopharmaceutical Science (WD_SMBIO_B)	3 / 6 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc (Hons) in Pharmaceutical Science (WD_SPHSC_B)	3 / 6 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc (Hons) in Physics for Modern Technology (WD_KPHTE_B)	3 / 6 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)	2 / 4 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc in Food Science with Business (WD_SFDCS_D)	3 / 5 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc in Forestry (WD_SFORS_D)	2 / 4 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc in Horticulture (Botanic Gardens) (WD_SHORT_DX)	2 / 4 / E
SCIE-0085	BSc in Horticulture (Waterford-Kildalton) (WD_SHORT_D)	2 / 4 / E

Indicative Content

- Student will fully participate in a minimum of 15 weeks professional development: whereby the student will plan learning objectives with the module supervisor, demonstrate continuous progress towards these objectives, avail of learning opportunities and communicate outcomes in a timely manner.
- The student, with support from the module supervisor, will participate in the WIT Science Industry committee and in a range of: industry/professional bodies' conferences; seminars; professional development activities; and/or certified training.
- The student will identify, assess and analyse, with prior agreement with the module supervisor, a piece of knowledge, technology or skill and its application relevant to the student's main study area. The student will carry out a project and communicate the results.

- The student will be provided with opportunities to relate, communicate and work with others and/or work independently to meet the agreed learning objectives.

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Plan learning objectives for the Science Professional Development semester.
2. Apply competently their science knowledge and skills in a range of settings, operating independently and/or as part of a team towards the set learning objectives.
3. Demonstrate the student has started their personal & professional development in acquiring transferable competences that characterise operating as a professional, including self-evaluation, personal responsibility and effectiveness, communication and operating in a multidisciplinary environment.
4. Demonstrate the ability to reflect critically on their personal, professional and technical achievements in this module.
5. Identify, assess and analyse a particular piece of knowledge, technology or skill and its application relevant to the student's main study area.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- A Department of Science workshop on planning and preparing for the Science Professional Development module.
- Scheduled communication between student and supervisor before, during and after the Science Professional Development module, to ensure successful outcomes.
- Student engagement with the WIT Science Industry Board and industry groups relevant to the student's main study area, facilitated by the module supervisor.
- Industry-supervised or self-directed project / training, focused on a specific piece of knowledge, skill or technology and its application to the student's main programme specialisation.
- A portfolio that may include some or all the following: a daily work diary, a reflective journal and/or presentation detailing the student's gain of experience and the development and evaluation of personal and professional understanding, learning and growth.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	1, 2, 3, 4, 5
<i>Portfolio</i>	100%	1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Assessment Criteria

Fail: Student fails to undertake or complete Science Professional Development to a satisfactory level and/or fails to submit the assessments and documents related to the learning outcomes.

Pass: Minimum period of at least 15 weeks Science Professional Development completed to a satisfactory standard with Supervisors Report, assessments and documents related to the learning outcomes, all submitted to an acceptable standard and submitted within deadlines.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Placement	810	

Essential Material

- "WIT Moodle: Science Professional Development folder: preparation, support and assessment documentation and resources.." <https://www.wit.ie/>. <https://moodle.wit.ie/>

Supplementary Material

- "Knowing Yourself - Guide to Self-Assessment | CareersPortal.ie." <https://careersportal.ie/>. https://careersportal.ie/careerplanning/self_assessment.php?parent=11&ed_sub_cat_id=13&menu_parent_id=